

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

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Last week: DJIA 40212.71 ▲ 1897.85 4.95% NASDAQ 16724.46 ▲ 7.3% STOXX 600 486.80 ▼ 1.9% 10-YR. TREASURY (Reopening) yield 4.492% OIL \$61.50 ▼ \$0.49 EURO \$1.1362 YEN 143.52

What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **Mixed signals from the Trump administration** over the weekend regarding tariffs on smartphones, laptops and other electronics fueled fresh uncertainty over U.S. trade policy, setting up another chaotic week on Wall Street and in Washington. **A1, B1**

◆ **The shock from Trump's initial tariff barrage**, partially reversed only as a result of a U.S. market rout with additional exceptions adopted last week, has added to months of concerns about how much America can be relied upon. **A1, A4**

◆ **Trump's tariffs are** challenging the assumptions everyday Americans have clung to for the past two decades, testing their tendency to stay invested no matter how rocky markets get. **B1**

◆ **Hedge-fund traders** world-wide have been whipped in the current market environment, where yesterday's losers can be tomorrow's winners. **B1**

◆ **Small U.S. businesses**, which account for roughly one-third of annual imports, are on track to be the biggest losers from Trump's new tariff regime. **B3**

◆ **One small seller on Amazon** is emblematic of the vulnerability of merchants reliant on shipments from China in a climate of escalating duties. **B4**

◆ **Sam Bankman-Fried**, who had hoped to win freedom with a long-shot bid for a presidential pardon, began the next stage of his life as a federal inmate. **B4**

World-Wide

◆ **Iran sought** sanctions relief from the U.S. in exchange for limits on its nuclear program during indirect talks that have opened the way to more serious negotiations. **A9**

◆ **The FAA said** the helicopter tour operator behind the Hudson River crash that killed a Spanish family of five and a pilot is shutting down. **A3**

◆ **Israeli strikes across** Gaza killed at least 21 people, with one hitting the last major hospital providing critical healthcare in the northern part of the strip. **A8**

◆ **A man suspected of** setting fire to the Pennsylvania governor's home was arrested and will be charged with attempted murder and terrorism, authorities said. **A3**

◆ **Trump is in** "excellent cognitive and physical health," his physician said after the president underwent his annual physical examination. **A3**

◆ **Ecuadoreans re-elected** President Daniel Noboa, giving him another chance to carry out a crackdown on gangs waging a war for control of cocaine routes to the U.S. **A9**

◆ **Colorado's governor** signed a law banning the sale of a range of firearms with detachable magazines, a measure meant to restrict the speed with which a shooter can reload. **A3**

◆ **Trump threatened** to punish Mexico if it doesn't address an arrears in the supply of river water to the U.S. that is damaging crop production in Texas. **A3**

◆ **Died:** Mario Vargas Llosa, Peru's Nobel Prize-winning author, 89. **A9**

JOURNAL REPORT

Encore: What memento do you want to be remembered for? **R1-10**

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Russian Airstrike Kills 34 in Ukraine



VOLODYMYR HORODENKO/ASSOCIATED PRESS

SHATTERED: A Russian ballistic-missile attack on the northern Ukrainian city of Sumy killed at least 34 people on Palm Sunday, Ukrainian officials said, striking a bus and leaving bodies strewn across a central street in the war's deadliest attack on civilians this year. **A8**

Flood of Emergency Cases Tests the Supreme Court

By JESS BRAVIN

WASHINGTON—A cascade of Trump administration cases is flooding the Supreme Court, putting the justices on the spot over the administration's aggressive moves to eliminate federal programs, abolish independent agencies and recast immigration law without congressional approval.

In past years, almost any one of the cases could have been a potential milestone,

with briefings and arguments over months leading to a landmark opinion on the bounds of executive power. Now, however, the number and speed of the administration's moves are pressuring the Supreme Court in ways rarely seen. In less than two months, the Trump administration already has filed emergency requests with the Supreme Court 10 times. Last week alone, the court has grappled with four of them: two on deportations, one on

the firing of federal workers, and one on the removal of independent agency officials.

"I think what we've seen in the last 2½ months is just how mismatched in the modern world these two institutions—the executive and judicial branches—are," said Vikram Amar, a law professor at the University of California, Davis. The executive branch can act quickly in several areas at once, while the courts are "ponder-
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McIlroy Wins First Masters



MICHAEL REAVES/GETTY IMAGES

FITTING VICTORY: Rory McIlroy dons the classic green jacket after capturing the only Grand Slam event he hadn't won. He is the sixth golfer to win all four Grand Slam tournaments. **A14**

Bad Quarter? Dial Up Your Astrologer

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Executives facing decisions look to stars and planets

By SHAN LI

AND AAKASH HASSAN

Ashish Bansal first consulted an astrologer during a period of business turmoil. Her top tip for the New Delhi commodities exporter: focus on selling white-colored products, because his birth chart was closely aligned with the white moon.

Nearly a decade later, 98% of Bansal's business is exporting rice. White rice.

The 42-year-old now regularly calls a roster of soothsayers for advice when facing tough career decisions. The priciest charges more than \$1
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More Original Movies Flop at the Box Office

By BEN FRITZ

LOS ANGELES—When director Christopher Landon introduced his new thriller, "Drop," before its premiere at the Chinese Theater on Hollywood's Walk of Fame, he had a warning for the packed auditorium.

"It's really hard out there for an original movie," he said, urging everyone who liked the Universal Pictures release to "scream it from the rooftops" and on social media.

"Drop" opened this weekend to an estimated \$7.5 million domestically, one of two new movies based on fresh ideas that fizzled at the box office. The other was Disney's "The Amateur," a spy thriller adapted from a little-known 1981 book, which opened to an estimated \$15 million.

After years of gripes from average moviegoers and Hollywood insiders alike about the

seemingly nonstop barrage of sequels, spin-offs, and adaptations of comic books and toys, the film industry placed more bets on original ideas.

The results have been ugly. Nearly every movie released by a major studio in the past year based on an original script or a little-known book has been a box-office disappointment. Before this weekend's flops were Warner Bros. Discovery's "Mickey 17" and "The Alto Knights," Paramount's "Novocaine," Apple's "Fly Me to the Moon," Amazon's "Red One," and the independently financed "Horizon: An American Saga Chapter 1" and "Megalopolis."

Jason Blum, who produced "Drop" and built his company Blumhouse largely on original horror franchises, said audiences' preference for known properties has made it harder to release original movies in
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Signal Shifts On Tech Cloud Tariff Outlook

Commerce chief says some products face separate levies after exemption notice

By AMRITH RAMKUMAR
AND JOHN MCCORMICK

Mixed signals from the Trump administration over the weekend regarding tariffs on smartphones, laptops and other electronics fueled fresh uncertainty over U.S. trade policy, setting up another chaotic week on Wall Street and in Washington.

Tech investors briefly rejoiced when a notice from U.S. Customs and Border Protection posted late Friday said computers, tablets, Apple watches, computer monitors, semiconductor equipment and other electronics were exempted from many tariffs on Chinese products and a 10%

tariff on all U.S. imports.

Administration officials on Sunday, including Commerce Secretary Howard Lutnick, said the tech products exempted from many tariffs will face separate levies in a month or two as part of a trade investigation into semiconductors. White House trade adviser Peter Navarro said Sunday the official policy is "no exemptions, no exclusions."

"There was no tariff 'exception' announced on Friday," Trump said on his Truth Social platform Sunday, adding that the products will be in the
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Spurned U.S. Allies Sit Out Trade War

By YAROSLAV TROFIMOV

America needs its allies and partners for what is shaping up as a protracted contest for geopolitical primacy now that President Trump has unleashed a trade war against China. They are in no rush to take sides.

Some 70 nations now negotiating tariff relief with the U.S. should "approach China as a group" together with Washington, Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent urged last week. Other U.S. officials suggested joint efforts to starve China of modern technologies and trade opportunities.

The problem is, many European and Asian partners aren't

sure to what extent they are still allied with Washington. Trump's initial "Liberation Day" order, after all, slapped them with sky-high tariffs that made no distinction between long-term adversaries and faithful allies.

The shock from this attack, partially reversed only as a result of a U.S. market rout, with additional exceptions quietly adopted on Friday, has added to months of concerns about how much Trump's America can be relied upon in an increasingly brutal world. That is
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◆ **Brazil offers clues on protectionist impact.....** A4

A Gambler Called 'The Joker' Took Down the Texas Lottery

A global team of gambling whizzes hatched a scheme to snag a \$57.8 million jackpot, buying millions of tickets in 72 hours

By JOE WALLACE AND KATHERINE SAYRE

In the spring of 2023, a London banker-turned-bookmaker reached out to a few contacts with an audacious request: Can you help me take down the Texas lottery?

Bernard Marantelli had a plan in mind. He and his partners would buy nearly every possible number in a coming drawing. There were 25.8 million potential number combinations. The tickets were \$1 apiece. The jackpot was heading to \$95 million. If nobody else

also picked the winning numbers, the profit would be nearly \$60 million.

Marantelli flew to the U.S. with a few trusted lieutenants. They set up shop in a defunct dentist's office, a warehouse and two other spots in Texas. The crew worked out a way to get official ticket-printing terminals. Trucks hauled in dozens of them and reams of paper.

Over three days, the machines—manned by a disparate bunch of associates and some of
Please turn to page A10

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